

7-Day Litter Box Reset Checklist

Companion to the Cat Litter Box Rescue Guide

Before You Start

- ☐ Vet appointment booked (urinalysis + physical exam)
- ☐ Rule out UTI / FLUTD / kidney disease before proceeding

Day 1: Box Audit

- [] Count boxes: $N \text{ cats} + 1 = \text{minimum boxes}$
- [] Check size: 1.5x cat length, no hoods/lids
- [] Check location: quiet, no dead-end corners, two escape routes
- [] Remove litter liners (cats hate the crinkle)

Day 2: Litter Swap

- [] Unscented, clumping, fine-grained (Dr. Elsey's preferred)
- [] Fill 3-4 inches deep, not shallow
- [] Keep ONE box with old litter as transition option

Day 3: Deep Clean

- [] Dump all litter, wash boxes with hot water + mild dish soap
- [] NO ammonia cleaners, NO bleach, NO vinegar
- [] Dry thoroughly before refilling
- [] Apply enzyme cleaner to all accident spots (Rocco & Roxie or Anti-Icky Poo)

Day 4: Stress Assessment

- ☐ Check for multicat tension (hissing, blocking, staring)
- ☐ Add Feliway diffuser in problem area
- ☐ Create vertical space (shelves, cat trees, window perches)
- ☐ Separate food/water from litter boxes

Day 5: Scoop Protocol

- ☐ Scoop minimum 2x daily
- ☐ Full dump + wash every 2 weeks
- ☐ Line boxes with newspaper only (no plastic liners)

Day 6: Observation

- ☐ Track elimination: box vs outside, frequency, consistency
- ☐ Note any straining, blood, or crying during urination
- ☐ Flag anything concerning → return to vet

Day 7: Reset Complete

- ☐ Review tracking log for patterns
- ☐ One change at a time going forward (not everything at once)
- ☐ If resolved: maintain the system
- ☐ If unresolved: consult a veterinary behaviorist

Built for cats who deserve better than guesswork.